

ACCENTED DISSONANCES

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #140

Most of the time, we musicians work with "tension and release." In much art, and certainly in music, we create a tension, and then if we do it correctly, we release it. No harm done.

But, that can also become a little boring and predictable. If your listener gets used to the ebb and flow of "a little tension, a little release," they might begin to wonder why they are listening at all. They begin to know what is coming next, and when it's going to happen.

ALL great art (good design, interesting conversations) has as a hallmark some unexpected tensions. Tensions that go unanswered, or tensions where the audience has to wait and think a bit. Places where they have to live with that tension for a few moments. In music, we can achieve this effect by putting the dissonance/tension in an accented position in the measure. The actual "cause" of the dissonance" (a #11, or a #9, or almost any odd note) is perhaps less important than how and where we place it.

#1 - Accented Dissonance on the I chord



#2 - Accented Dissonance on the V chord



#3 - Accented Dissonance on the ii chord

